2 Docker and the install

FULL

03. Your garden at home: password, email, AI, first edits

Quick version

No time to read it all? This is the short version. The full guide is below.

- This guide gets your garden working at home at `http://localhost:8030`: your password, email, the AI boxes and a first edit.
- It takes 30 minutes after the install. Free.
- Open the garden: menu `4`.
- Set your password: menu `U`, then `5` (at least 10 characters).
- Email for "forgot password" links (optional): make a Gmail app password, then menu `8`, then `3`.
- AI boxes (optional): make a free key at https://aistudio.google.com/apikey, then menu `8`, `4`, `1` (Gemini), then `1` again (Paste a new key).
- Log in at `http://localhost:8030/login.php` and change a plant in the plant admin (`/streamlit/`). (From Windows with a separate garden computer: Windows menu `4`, then add `/login.php` to the end of the address it opened.)
- Time zone: the install uses the computer's own. To change it: menu `8`, then `2`.
- It worked when the checklist (menu `5`) ends with 0 fail.

What you will build

Your garden running on the garden computer at `http://localhost:8030`, with all your plants and photos, your own password, email for "forgot password" links, and the AI boxes working.

Time and cost

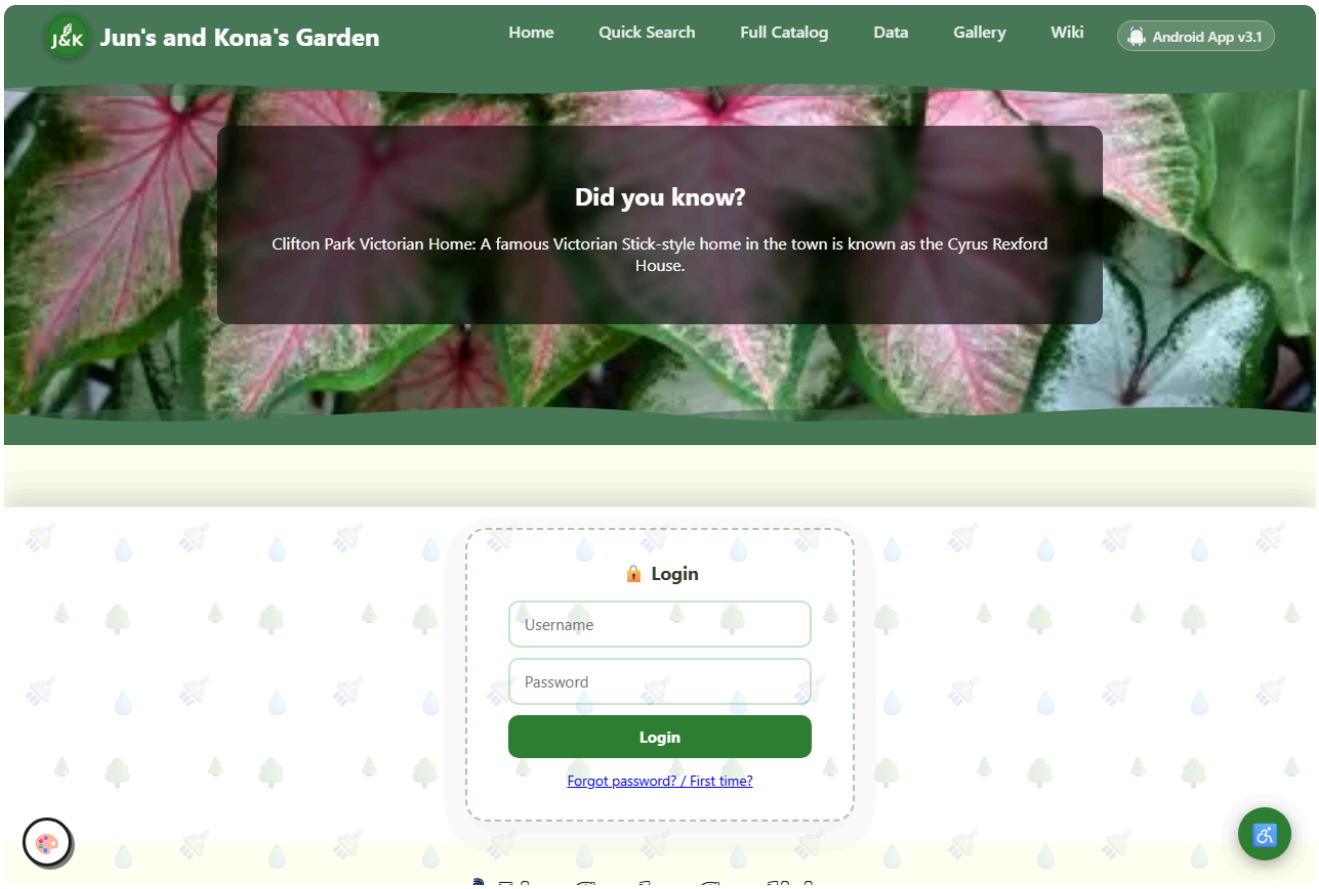
30 minutes after the install. Free.

What you need first

The install is done (menu `1` said **ALL DONE**). If not, see `00-READ-ME-FIRST.html` in the garden folder. The longest part of the install is building the website: 15 to 45 minutes (up to an hour on a very old laptop or a Pi).

Steps

Part A. Open your garden



On the garden computer, menu `4` (or open `http://localhost:8030`). *You should see:* your home page, and the catalogue full of plants. From Windows, the Windows menu `4` opens it through a secure tunnel.

Part B. Your password

The install offered this at the end. If you skipped it: menu `U`, then `5`. It sets ONE password for the website login and your sign-in page. At least 10 characters. Nothing shows while you type.

Part C. Email for "forgot password" links (optional)

The site sends mail through your Gmail with an **app password**: a separate password just for this, not your normal Gmail password. 1. Open your Google account, **Security**, and turn on **2-Step Verification**. 2. In Security, find **App passwords** (https://myaccount.google.com/apppasswords). Make one named `garden`. Google shows it once. 3. Menu `8` Settings, then `3` (Email). Type your Gmail address, then paste the app password (`Ctrl+Shift+V`; it is hidden). Say **y** to the test email. *You should see:* "Sent", and the email arrives (check spam the first time).

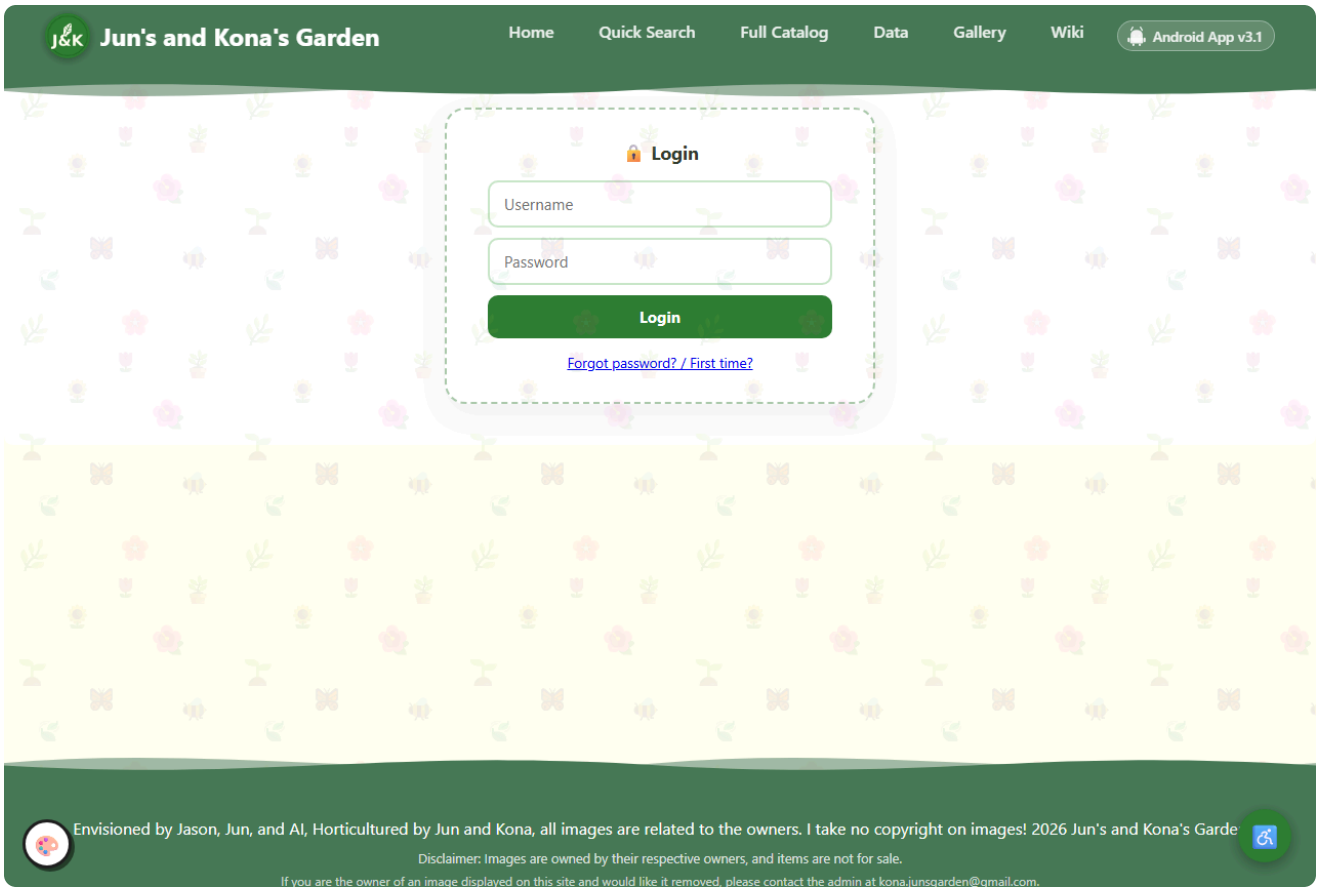
Google's own help: https://support.google.com/accounts/answer/185833

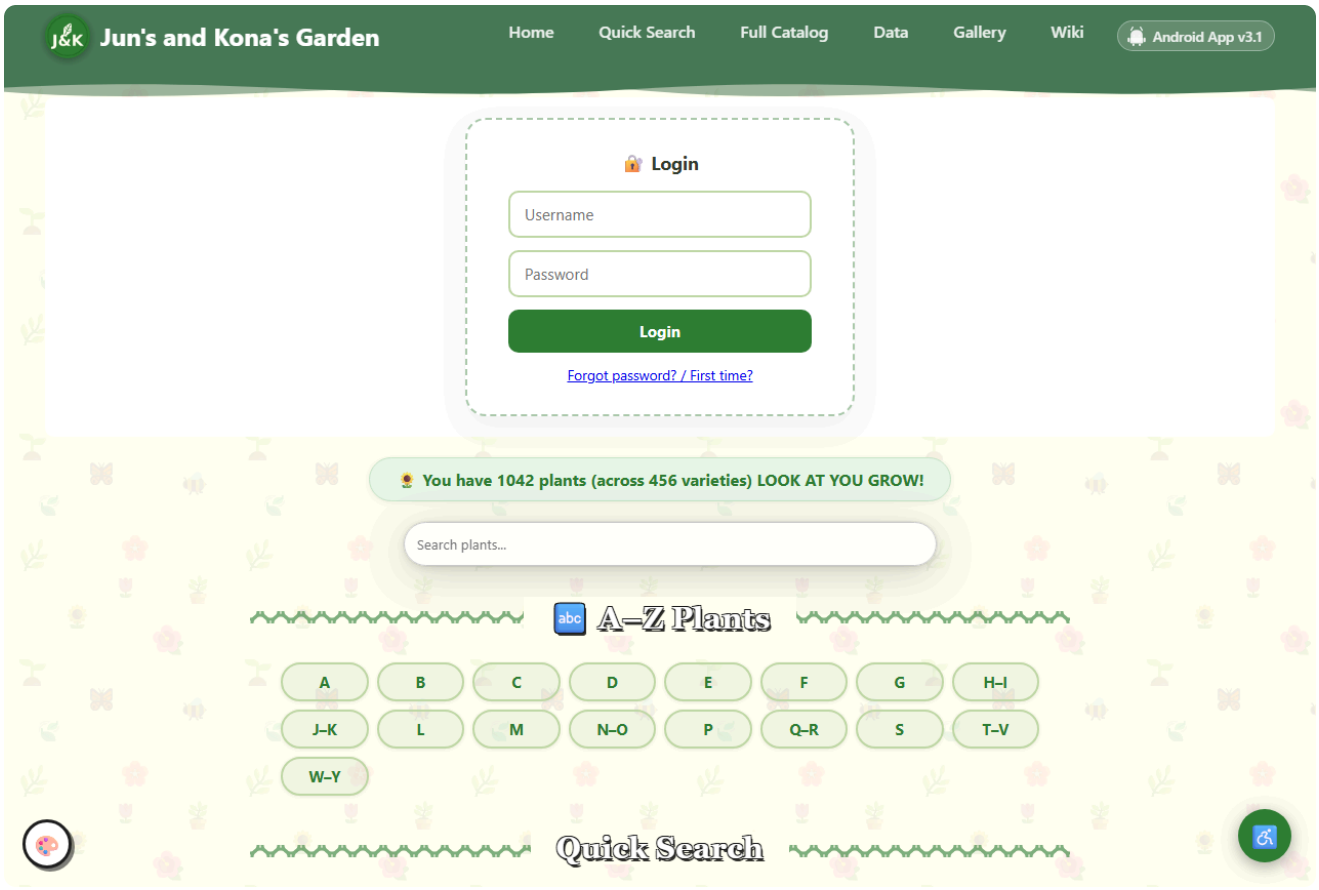
Part D. The AI boxes (optional)

Some pages have AI helpers (plant health, identify, tag reading). They use Google's free Gemini service when you give the garden a key. 1. Make a free key at https://aistudio.google.com/apikey (guide 16 explains). 2. Menu `8` Settings, then `4` (API keys), then `1` (Gemini), then `1` again (**Paste a new key (or replace the old one)**). Paste the key: it is hidden, saved in `.env`, and tested for you.

Without a key, those boxes say AI is not set up. Everything else works. A free key is enough for a home garden. Paying for more is your choice, on your own Google account, with a spending limit (guide 16, "More than the free limits").

Part E. Log in and change a plant

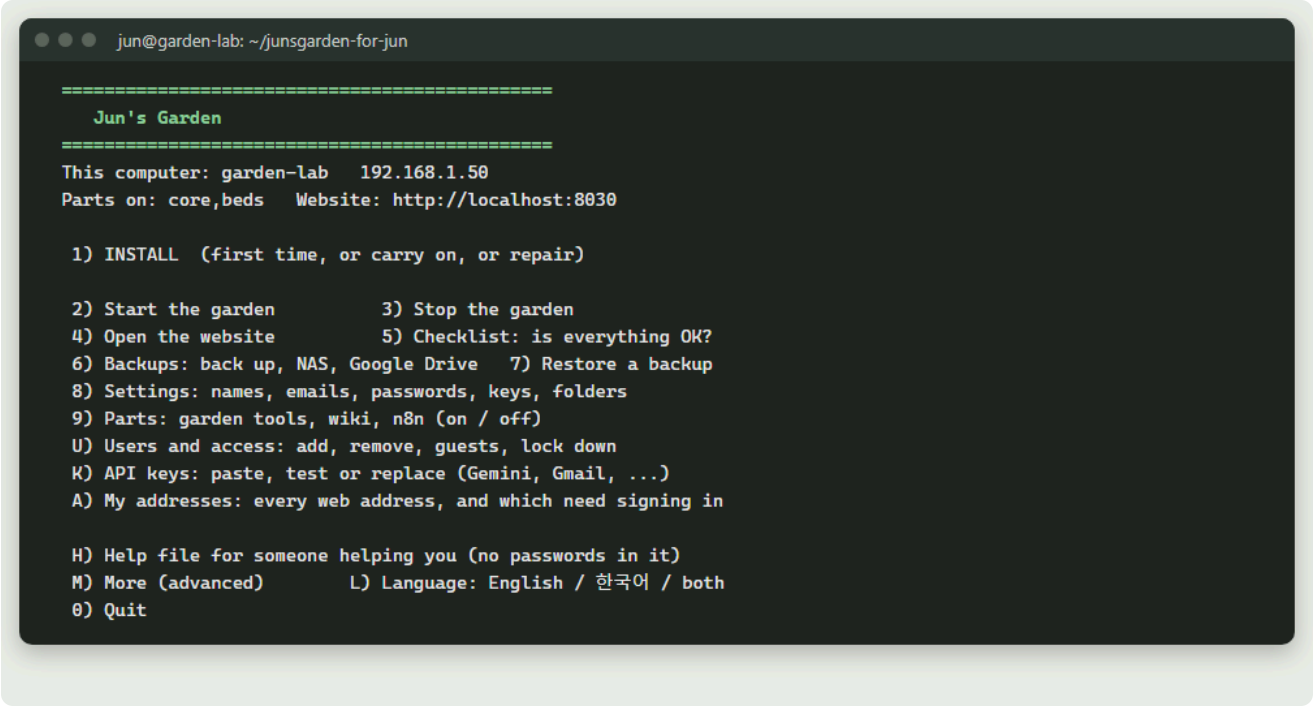




1. Open `http://localhost:8030/login.php` and log in with your name and password.
2. Open the plant admin at `http://localhost:8030/streamlit/`. Its tabs let you add and edit plants.
3. Open `http://localhost:8030/catalog.php` and find the plant you changed.

Using Windows with a separate garden computer? Then addresses like `http://localhost:8030/login.php` do not open on the PC (the garden is on the other computer). Use the Windows menu `4` (Open the website); then add `/login.php` to the end of the address it opened (the same for `/streamlit/` and `/catalog.php`). Keep the extra window it opened while you work: that window is the secure tunnel.

Everyday jobs (the menu)



I want to	Menu
Start / stop the garden	`2` / `3`
Open the website	`4`
Check everything is OK	`5`
Make a backup now / put one back	`6`, then `1` / `7`
Change name, email, keys, folders	`8`
Change the time zone (it starts as the computer's own)	`8`, then `2`
Switch the garden tools, wiki or n8n on or off	`9`
Add or remove people, guests, lock down	`U`
See what the programs have been saying	`M`, then `6`

How you know it worked

- The catalogue shows your plants with photos.
- You can log in and save a change.
- The checklist (menu `5`) ends with 0 fail.

If something goes differently

What you see	What to do
The page does not open	Menu `2` (start), then menu `5`. It says which part is down.
Login says wrong password	Menu `U`, `5` to set it again. After 5 wrong tries it waits 15 minutes.
No password email	Settings, `3`, and send the test email. It says what Gmail did not like.
Plants but no photos	Checklist section 4: the images folder must have files. Guide 13.
Anything else	Menu `H` makes a help file; guide 09 has more fixes.

Make it yours

- Change a colour in `site/style.css` (guide 11, example 1).
- Write a blog post from the website.
- Add a plant you bought this year, with a photo.

Next: Project 1: Uptime Kuma, or 11 How your website works.